

Plutarch





About the Course

Plutarch's Lives is a collection of biographies written 2,000 years ago, which has influenced prominent thinkers from Montaigne to Bacon to Shakespeare. Plutarch's stories are often difficult to read (and are therefore often dropped by teachers), but their value to help students evaluate the characteristics that define a good citizen cannot be overstated. The lesson plans will contain additional support to what is already included in the Anne White guides.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Citizenship: Grade 6, Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.), Citizenship: Grade 7 (Canada), Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.), Citizenship: Grade 8 (Canada)



Placement & Combining Tips

Students in 5th grade or new to Plutarch may want to take the Beginner's Track, which covers the life of Publicola over two terms. It is advisable to have students read Beesly's Stories From the History of Rome and complete one year of Shakespeare before beginning Plutarch.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
6-8+	Plutarch: Grades 6-8 1 time/week 30 min	Historical Atlas of the World 6th Ed. The Plutarch Project Volume Three (Revised)

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Citizenship: Grade 6				
	Plutarch: Grades 6-8	Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12		Current Events: Grades 5-8
Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.)				
Ethics: Part 1 Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12		American Government: Grade 7		Plutarch: Grades 6-8 Current Events: Grades 5-8
Citizenship: Grade 7 (Canada)				
Ethics: Part 1 Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12		Canadian Government: Grade 7		Plutarch: Grades 6-8 Current Events: Grades 5-8
Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)				
Ethics: Part 2 Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12		American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 Current Events: Grades 5-8		Plutarch: Grades 6-8
Citizenship: Grade 8 (Canada)				
Ethics: Part 2 Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12		Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 Current Events: Grades 5-8		Plutarch: Grades 6-8



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

- ☐ Watch the video in Quick Links about teaching Plutarch.
- ☐ Make sure your student sets up a Citizenship Notebook. They will need a 3-ring binder, lined notebook paper, and 5 Tabbed Dividers. You can read more about how to set one up and suggestions for various sections in the document in Quick Links.
- ☐ As desired, plan for a read aloud time. Suggestions are provided in the Community Read Aloud Quick Link, but local favorites are highly recommended whenever possible.
- ☐ Make a Calendar of Events for Current Events lessons by drawing a calendar grid in a notebook (or print a blank calendar from the internet).
- ☐ Make sure your student sets up a Citizenship Notebook. They will need a 3-ring binder, lined notebook paper, and 5 Tabbed Dividers. You can read more about how to set one up and suggestions for various sections in the document in Quick Links.
- ☐ As desired, plan for a read-aloud time. Suggestions are provided in the Community Read Aloud Quick Link, but local favorites are highly recommended whenever possible.
- ☐ Make a Calendar of Events for Current Events lessons by drawing a calendar grid in a notebook (or print a blank calendar from the internet).



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Plutarch: Grades 6-8



Historical Atlas of the World 6th Ed.



The Plutarch Project Volume Three (Revised)



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)
(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Plutarch: Grades 6-8

∞ [Video: How to Teach Plutarch \(see Citizenship: Section 7\)](#)

Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.



Related Course Quick Links

- ∞ [Community Read Alouds](#)
- ∞ [Setting Up a Citizenship Notebook](#)

Plutarch: Grades 6-8

How To Teach



Prepare

Plutarch: Teachers will find it helpful to preread the entire Life first, and then preread the day's passage before each lesson. Mark any passages that should be omitted due to content. (In Anne White's Plutarch Project books, the recommended source for this course, objectionable content has already been omitted.)

Current Events: Preview the news source for suitability.

Most other citizenship topics don't require additional prep.



Recap

Connect back to the previous lesson. (Optional for Current Events).



Introduce

For news sources, show students how to scan the headlines to get an overview first and then choose a story to read.

For Plutarch or other books: Use a picture, a map, or an engaging question to prepare students to receive the story as relevant. You may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding. It is not necessary to cover all unfamiliar words.



Read

Read the selection assigned or the news story chosen. For rich, dense, or more challenging books such as *Ourselves and Plutarch*, it is a good idea to read them aloud. Have students keep an eye out for things to add to their Citizenship Notebook, Book of Centuries, and/or Commonplace book.



Narrate

Have the students narrate orally or in writing.



Discuss

Give students an opportunity to share their thoughts on the story and any connections made. For current events, look up where events occurred on a map and ask questions to help students discern the quality of the piece. (e.g., Are there sources cited? Is there an obvious bias? If so, what do other authors have to say on this subject? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?) Consider reading an alternative perspective.



Citizenship Notebook

Have students record important ideas in their Citizenship Notebooks.

Plutarch: Grades 6-8

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Term 1

WEEK 1 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 1

Julius Caesar p.1-12

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP:

- We highly recommend reading a retelling so you can be familiar with the story. This is for your understanding and should not be read to the students.
- ∞ Link: Retelling of Caesar (from Our Young Folks' Plutarch)
- Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ INTRO

Have you ever heard of Julius Caesar? If so, what do you know about him?

→ VIEW

- ∞ Image Link: Julius Caesar Image
- ∞ Video Link: Julius Caesar Video

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Take 1-2 minutes to look over the map of the Roman Republic and the surrounding "world" in Caesar's time.
2. Find Rome in Italy.
3. Find the Aegean Sea between the province of Asia and Achaea. This is the coastline where the pirates operated.
4. Find Bithynia on the southern shore of the Black Sea, where Caesar went after his release.
5. These are the places where a teenager on the wrong side of Roman politics spent his first years away from home.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson One: Parts One - Three p.9-12

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

In the introduction of Lesson One, we learn that "young Julius Caesar was on the wrong side. Most people in that position would have stayed hidden or at least tried to live quietly" (p.7). In a situation where staying silent means comfort and safety, what factors or beliefs might make a person decide that standing up is worth the risk?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

If you found yourself on the "wrong side" of a big decision at school or with your friends, and staying quiet was the only way to stay safe and comfortable, how would you decide which ideas are worth being "exiled" for and which ones are just you being stubborn?

★ TEACHER TIP

∞ Link: Character Cards
To keep track of all of the characters in the story, it may be helpful for your student to keep a list or chart of some kind in their citizenship notebook. They could also sketch the characters and include facts about them. Or, you could use the linked character cards.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Watch this overview video to help with the Character Simulator
∞ Video Link: Character Simulator

• CHARACTERS

-**Julius Caesar (JOOL-yus, SEE-zar):** Roman statesmen and general, held many high civic, military, and religious positions, and was a noted orator and writer.

-**Sulla (SUH-luh):** was made the Perpetual Dictator, but resigned after one year and was elected as a consul instead.

-**Cinna (SIN-uh):** There are several Cinnas in the story. This Cinna, Lucius Cornelius Cinna the Elder, is Caesar's first father-in-law and ally of Marius, Caesar's uncle.

-**Marius (MARR-ee-us):** involved in a Civil War against Sulla and was an ally of Cinna, the father-in-law of Caesar

-**King Nicomedes (nih-kuh-MEE-deez):** King of Bithynia 94-74 BC

-**Marcus Juncus (MAHR-kuss, JUNG-kuss):** governor of Asia in 75 BC

WEEK 2 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 2

Julius Caesar p.12-17

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

★ TEACHER NOTE

The map shows the world in 31 BC, shortly after Caesar's time. You will notice Italy is shaded pink; while it was the Roman Homeland and not a province, it is colored here to show it was under

Plutarch: Grades 6-8

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Term 1

→ RECAP

What did we learn so far about Caesar from the first reading?

→ LOCATE

📍 Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Hither Spain and Farther Spain on the western edge of the map. Both are already "Roman Pink."
2. Find the Alps. This is the route Caesar traveled when he passed through a tiny village and said, "For my part, I had rather be the chiefest man here, than the second person in Rome" (p.15, The Plutarch Project).

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful to write definitions into the text, so you do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Two: Parts One - Three p.14-17

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are a young officer who rode with Caesar when he passed through a tiny village in the Alps and said he would rather be the first man there than the second in Rome. What do you think about that comment?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Explain how you might distinguish between a person who wants to do great things and a person who simply wants to be the greatest.

central Roman control.

While all of Gaul is pink on this map, remember that when Caesar began his command, only the southern tip belonged to Rome. His campaigns are what eventually brought the rest of that territory into the Empire.

• DEFINITIONS

Pontifex Maximus: There were numerous levels and types of priesthood in Rome and throughout the rest of Italy, and these positions carried political as well as spiritual authority.

• CHARACTERS

-Catulus (kuh-TUL-uhs): an avowed enemy to the Marian (Marius's) party

-Isauricus (eye-SAW-rih-kus): a consul and general who fought against the Cilician pirates

-Crassus (KRAS-us): Roman senator and a conspirator against Caesar

-Cato (KAY-toe): statesmen that had many conflicts of opinion against Caesar

-Alexander (al-ig-ZAN-der): Alexander the Great

-Calpurnius Bibulus (kal-PUR-nee-us, BIB-yoo-lus): consul alongside Caesar

WEEK 3 📅 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 3

Julius Caesar p.17-24

📍 Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

📍 Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Transalpine Gaul and the Rhine River marking the boundary between Gaul and Germania.
2. Notice that Germania is entirely outside the Roman pink. This is the boundary Caesar was about to push.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Germania was entirely outside Roman control.

- The Rhine was the line Caesar pushed against, even crossing it twice (in 55 BC and 53 BC) to build famous bridges and conduct show of force expeditions.

- Despite these incursions, Rome never successfully turned the main body of Germania into a permanent province, even in the centuries following Caesar.

• CULTURAL CONNECTION

Sweet Ointment: also translated "oil of perfume" or "myrrh." It appears that Valerius Leo hadn't just pulled out the wrong bottle of salad dressing, but rather that he was trying to show off his wealth.



Term 1

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Three: Parts One - Three p.19-23

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are one of Caesar's soldiers who has watched him for days while he was ill and exhausted. Tonight he is sick again. What do you think about his choices while chronically ill (p.22)?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Describe the different ways Caesar and his companions responded to the dish served by their host in Milan (p.23).

The reference to the host's want of breeding seems to confirm that.

• CHARACTERS

-**Servilius Caepio (ser-VIL-ee-us, SEE-pee-oh):** engaged to Caesar's daughter, Julia

-**Piso (PEE-so):** consul in 58 BC

-**Clodius (KLOH-dee-us):** interrupted a women's religious ritual and was the cause of Caesar's divorce from Pompeia

WEEK 4 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 4

Julius Caesar p.24-30

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find the Rhine separating Gaul from Germania.
2. Find Cisalpine Gaul south of the Alps.
3. Trace north from Cisalpine Gaul all the way to the Rhine. This is the distance those men were willing to march.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Four: Parts One - Four p.26-30

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

Caesar "never failed to dismiss all with present pledges of his kindness in hand, and further hopes for the future" (p.29). As one of his soldiers, you've just watched him march over a bridge of fallen soldiers. Now, he stands before you, gives you gold, and speaks of the future with hope. How do you make sense of the leader you saw at the river and the generous, hopeful man standing in front of you now?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Caesar "commanded them that were afraid, that they should depart home, and not put themselves in danger against their wills" (p.27-28). How would you respond if you were one of the "young gentlemen of noble houses of Rome, who thought to have gone to the wars with him as only for their pleasure and gain" and Caesar was sending you home (p.27)?

• CHARACTERS

-**Labienus (lay-bee-EE-nuhs):** tribune, one of Caesar's lieutenants, but a supporter of Pompey

-**Ariovistus (ar-ee-oh-VIS-tus):** leader of the Suebi people, one of a group of Germanic tribes

Plutarch: Grades 6-8

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Term 1

WEEK 5 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 5

Julius Caesar p.30-36

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Arverni, where Vercingetorix and the Arverni lived.
2. Find Alesia. Notice the rivers and terrain, and consider why Caesar chose to build where he did.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Five: Parts One - Two p.32-36

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are Vercingetorix, riding out of the gates of Alesia in full armor to give yourself up. What do you think about the choice you are making?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Look closely at the rivers surrounding Alesia. How might these help a general trying to keep an army from escaping?

• CHARACTERS

-**Ambiorix (am-bee-OR-iks):** leader of the Eburones from Gaul

-**Quintus Tullius Cicero (KWIN-tuss, TUL-lee-uss, SIS-er-oh):** military leader during Caesar's Gallic Wars

-**Vercingetorix (VUR-sin-JET-uh-riks):** king of the captured Arverni tribe

WEEK 6 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 6

Julius Caesar p.36-42

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find the Rubicon.
2. Locate Brundisium on the Adriatic coast.
3. Find Dyrrhachium across the Ionian Sea and notice the distance Caesar was asking his army to cross.
4. Consider the risk of moving a massive force across that stretch of the Ionian Sea while being hunted by an enemy fleet.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Six: Parts One - Two p.38-42.

• CHARACTERS

-**Antony (AN-tuh-nee):** Mark Antony

-**Scipio (SIH-pih-oh):** senator, consul, and military commander

-**Lentulus (LEN-tyoo-lus):** consul

-**Asinius Pollio (uh-SIN-ee-us, POL-ee-oh):** Roman orator and historian



Term 1

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are Asinius Pollio, standing beside Caesar at the Rubicon while he talks through what crossing will mean. What do you think as you listen to him (p.41-42)?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

On the banks of the Rubicon, Caesar's abstract plan shifts to the reality of the action. Describe what he sees and feels in that moment of doubt as he considers the "desperateness of his attempt" (p.41).

WEEK 7 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 7

Julius Caesar p.42-50

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Trace the route Caesar used to move through Italy in sixty days without a major battle.
2. Find Corfinium, where Domitius surrendered.
3. Locate Brundisium, where Pompey escaped by sea.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Seven: Parts One - Four p.45-49

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are Labienus, Caesar's most trusted general for ten years, the night you walked out of his camp for the last time. What do you think about the man you are leaving (p.46)?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Caesar said, "Time of war and law are two things" (p.47). What does he mean?

• CHARACTERS

-Domitius (duh-MISH-ee-uhs): enemy of Caesar and Cato's brother-in-law

-Publius Servilius Isauricus (PUB-lee-uhs, ser-VIL-ee-uhs, eye-SAWR-ih-kuhs): co-consul and friend of Caesar

WEEK 8 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 8

Julius Caesar p.50-56

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find the city of Rome in Italy and cross the Adriatic Sea to the province

★ TEACHER NOTE

The writing prompt is slightly uncomfortable by design, because understanding someone's fears in order to respond more effectively sits right on the edge between wisdom and manipulation.

• CHARACTERS

-Spinther (SPIN-ther): nickname for Publius Cornelius Lentulus

Plutarch: Grades 6-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

of Macedonia, the rugged region where the Battle of Pharsalus was fought.

2. Find Pharsalus.

3. Trace the coastline south to Alexandria and the Kingdom of the Ptolemies, where the defeated Pompey eventually fled for refuge.

4. These are the locations where the future of the Roman world was decided as Caesar pursued his rival across the Mediterranean.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Eight, Parts One - Three p.51-56

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are one of Caesar's soldiers who ran to meet him when he returned to shore, and you are angry. Your general just risked his life sneaking across a war zone in a twelve-oar boat dressed as a slave, without telling anyone. What specifically bothers you about what he did, and what does your reaction say about what you believe a leader owes the people who follow him?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Caesar's plan to aim at the faces of the young cavalymen worked because he thought carefully about who they actually were, not just what they were doing on the battlefield. Describe a conflict or disagreement you have had where understanding the other person's specific fears or weaknesses would have changed how you approached the situation.

-Gnaeus Domitius Calvinus (NEE-us, doh-MISH-ee-us, cal-VYE-nus): general and consul and loyal to Caesar

-Quintus Cornificus (KWIN-tus, cor-NIF-ih-kus): quaestor for Illyricum

-Calenus (kuh-LEE-nuhs): Roman general and consul

WEEK 9 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 9

Julius Caesar p.57-62

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Alexandria on its Mediterranean coast. This is where Caesar spent months managing a dangerous court, a burning library, a treacherous eunuch, and a queen smuggled in through a castle gate in a bundle. He nearly drowned here.

2. Move northeast into Syria, which Caesar passed through on his way to deal with the next problem before the Egyptian one was fully settled.

3. Find Pontus on the southern shore of the Black Sea. This is where Pharnaces had overrun Roman territory while Caesar was occupied in Alexandria. Caesar arrived, fought, and sent a three-word letter back to Rome. The whole thing was over before the letter arrived.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

• CHARACTERS

-Cleopatra (KLEE-oh-PA-truh): co-ruler of Egypt with her brother, Ptolemy XIV

-Pothinus the Eunuch (PAH-thin-uhs): high-ranking servant of King Ptolemy XIII and regent of Ptolemy XIV

-Achillas (uh-KILL-uhss): guardian of King Ptolemy and one of the murderers of Pompey

-Caesarion (see-ZAR-ee-on): Caesar's son and last pharaoh of Egypt

-Pharnaces (FAR-nuh-seez): his father conquered many territories, including Bithynia and Cappadocia



Term 1

Lesson Nine: Parts One - Three p.58-61

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are one of Pompey's soldiers who has just been taken prisoner and is now being folded into Caesar's legions. Yesterday, you were fighting against this man. Today, he is your general. What do you do with that, and what would you need to see from him before you trusted him (p.58-59)?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE): PICK 1

Caesar "daily saved the lives of some of his countrymen that bore arms against him" and considered this the greatest pleasure of his victory. Think of a conflict, whether between people, groups, or ideas, where the most meaningful thing a winner could do afterward was show restraint or generosity. What makes that kind of choice hard, and what makes it worth it (p.59)?

"Veni, Vidi, Vici" worked because it was short, precise, and matched the reality of what had actually happened. Think of a time when you had to report something, explain yourself, or sum up a complicated situation for someone else. What is lost when we say too much, and what is lost when we say too little (p.61)?

WEEK 10 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 10

Julius Caesar p.62-69

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Sicily, where Caesar camped on the seashore in winter to cut off any thought of delay.
2. Then trace his crossing south to the African coast and the battle at Thapsus, where three camps fell in a single day.
3. Follow him back to Rome for the triumphs and the honors, then west to Spain and the battle at Munda, where Pompey's sons nearly killed him, and back to Rome again. He covered all of this inside two years.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Ten: Parts One - Three p.64-68

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are one of Caesar's friends who has just urged him to accept a personal bodyguard, and he has refused, saying it is "better to die once than always to be afraid of death." You believe there are real plots against him. How would you respond to his answer (p.68)?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

• CHARACTERS

-**Scipio (SIH-pih-oh):** senator, consul, and military commander

-**King Juba I (JOO-buh):** King of Numidia

-**Gaius Asinius Pollio (GAY-us, uh-SIN-ee-us, PAHL-ee-oh):** soldier, politician, historian, and writer

-**Afranius (uh-FRAY-nee-us):** former consul and Pompey's lieutenant in Spain

-**Juba II (JOO-buh):** King of Numidia and Mauretania, scholar and author, raised in Rome by Caesar and his nephew



Term 1

Caesar put a man of the right family name at the head of his troops specifically to counter an oracle his enemies believed in. He may have been mocking it, or he may have been sincere; Plutarch says it is hard to tell. Think about a time when you did something that could have been interpreted two very different ways depending on who was watching. Do your intentions fully determine the meaning of an action, or does it matter how others read it (p.65)?

WEEK 11 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 11

Julius Caesar p.69-82

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Rome. Now stay there, because that is where the entire lesson takes place. After a life of crossing seas and marching through impassable terrain, the whole lesson fits inside a single city.
2. Find Philippi in Macedonia, where Brutus and Cassius died by their own hands.
3. Trace the distance between those two points.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Eleven: Parts One - Three p.70-74 and Lesson Twelve: Parts One - Epilogue p.77-82

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR: PICK 1

You are a senator who walked out when Caesar refused to stand up to greet you. You said nothing. You just left. What were you communicating, and do you think he understood it?

You are Caesar in the moment before you cover your face and give up. You have fought off the others. You are still standing. And then you see Brutus. Something finally stops all the fight in you. You have outrun everything your whole life. What is it that you are finally deciding to stop outrunning (p.78)?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE): PICK 1

You have served Caesar since his early campaigns. You have watched him win in Gaul, survive civil war, defeat Pompey, and return to Rome in triumph. He is now planning new campaigns as if none of it had happened. What does it feel like to follow a man who cannot stop? What do you think he is still looking for?

The crowd killed Cinna the poet because he had the same name as Cinna the conspirator. He tried to tell them who he was, and it made no difference. Think about a situation where a person was judged entirely by

• CHARACTERS

-**Brutus (BROO-tuss):** wanted to preserve the Roman Republic and allied with a group of senators to murder Caesar

-**Tillius Cimber (TIL-ee-us, SIM-ber):** called Metellus Cimber in Shakespeare's play

-**Casca (KAS-kuh):** struck the first blow in the murder of Caesar

-**Octavius Caesar (ok-TAY-vee-us, SEE-zer):** later known as Caesar Augustus



Term 1	
something they had no control over. What does that kind of mistake reveal about what happens to people's judgment when they are driven by grief or rage (p.80)?	
WEEK 12 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 12 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: The Plutarch Project Volume 3	



Term 2

WEEK 1 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 13

Agis and Cleomenes p.84-99

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP:

- We highly recommend reading a retelling so you can be familiar with the story. This is for your understanding and should not be read to the students.
- ∞ Link: Our Young Folks' Plutarch - Agis
- ∞ Link: Our Young Folks' Plutarch - Cleomenes
- Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ VIEW

∞ Link: Agis Video

→INTRO

Have you ever heard of Sparta? If so, what do you know about it? What do you think made Sparta different from other ancient Greek cities?

→LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.7

1. Find Sparta in the southern part of Greece, tucked between the Laconian Gulf to the east and the Messenian Gulf to the west.
2. Now find Laconia, the region surrounding Sparta, and Messenia to its west.
3. Find Corinth at the narrow neck of land connecting the southern peninsula to the rest of Greece.
4. Agis's story takes place in this region.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Introduction and Lesson One: Parts One - Two p.84-93 and Lesson Two: Parts One - Three p.96-99

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR: PICK 1

Agis is not yet twenty years old. He has grown up with wealth and comfort provided by his mother and grandmother, the richest women in Sparta. Plutarch says he "began to spurn against these womanish delights and pleasures" and chose the plain Spartan life instead. Nobody made him do this. What do you think happened inside him, and what does his choice tell you about what kind of person he was becoming (p.91)?

Agis's mother and grandmother were the richest women in Sparta and had the most to lose from his reforms. They opposed him at first. Then something changed, and they not only consented but became his most vocal supporters, willing to give up their own wealth for his cause. What do you think changed their minds? What does their behavior tell you about those women (p.96)?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE): PICK 1

Agis "openly boasted besides, that he would not desire to be king, but only for the hope he had to restore the ancient Laconian life by his authority" (p.91). What do you think he meant?

• CHARACTERS

-**Agis (AY-jis)**: young king of Sparta

-**Agessilaus #1 (uh-JESS-uh-LAY-uhs)**: former king of Sparta

-**Pausanias (paw-SAY-nee-uhs)**: general and regent to the king in the 5th century

-**Seleucus (suh-LOO-kuhs)**: a former general of Alexander the Great

-**Lycurgus #1 (lie-KUR-gus)**: according to legend, was the lawgiver of Sparta

-**Lysander (ly-SAN-der)**: not the famous general, just named similarly

-**Agessilaus #2 (uh-JESS-uh-LAY-uhs)**: also spelled Agylaeus, was the uncle of Agis

-**Ptolemy III, #1 (TAH-luh-mee)**: the king of Egypt

-**Cleombrotus (klee-OM-broh-tos)**: king and son-in-law of Leonidas

Plutarch: Grades 6-8

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Term 2

Agésilas persuaded Agis to cancel the debts first and divide the land later, arguing that doing both at once might cause dangerous commotion. Then, Plutarch reveals his motives, "Agésilas...having the best lands of any man in the country, and owing a great sum of money besides, would neither pay his debts, nor let go his land" (p.99). Think about the difference between counsel and manipulation. How do you learn to tell the difference when someone gives you advice?

WEEK 2 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 14

Agis and Cleomenes p.100-107

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.7

1. Find Megara and Corinth.
2. The narrow strip of land between them is the Isthmus of Corinth, where the sea presses in from both sides (the Saronic Gulf and the Gulf of Corinth). The large peninsula below Corinth is the Peloponnese.
3. Neither label appears on this map, but you can see the shape clearly. Sparta is in the Southern Peloponnese region. This is the route Agis marched north with his young army to assist the Achaeans.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Three: Parts One - Three p.102-106

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

Agis was led to his death by men pretending to be his friends. When the moment came, he saw a sergeant weeping for him and said, "Good fellow, I pray thee weep not for me, for I am honestest man than they that so shamefully put me to death" (p.106). He was twenty years old. What do you notice about that moment?

→ WRITE

When the ephor asked if Agis repented of what he had done, he answered that "he would never repent him of so wise and virtuous an enterprise, though he ventured his life for it" (p.105-106). What do you think about that answer?

★ TEACHER NOTE

This week's lesson may feel heavy for some students. An honorable man dies with integrity.

• CHARACTERS

-**Aratus (uh-RAY-tuhs)**: elected general of the Achaean League seventeen times

WEEK 3 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 15

Agis and Cleomenes p.107-112

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Cleomenes Video

→ RECAP

• CHARACTERS

-**Archidamus (AAR-kih-DAY-mus)**: second in line to the Agiad throne

-**Sphaerus (SFEE-rus)**: a Stoic philosopher

-**Zeno of Citium (ZEE-noh, SISH-ee-um)**: founder of the Stoic school of philosophy



Term 2

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

📍 Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.7

Find Sparta. That's where this lesson takes place.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Four: Parts One - Three p.109-111

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

Cleomenes married Agiatis against her will, yet "immediately after he was married unto her, fell greatly in fancy with her, and for compassion's sake he thanked her for the love she bore unto her first husband" (p.109). What does that tell you about him?

→ WRITE

Plutarch says Cleomenes and Agis were alike in many ways, but that Cleomenes had "something of heat and passion always goading him on, and an impetuosity and violence in his eagerness to pursue anything which he thought good and just" (p.109). Do you think that is a strength or a weakness? Explain your answer.

WEEK 4 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 16

Agis and Cleomenes p.112-117

📄 Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

📍 Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.7

1. Find Arcadia, the highland region in the center of the peninsula.
2. Find Argos to its east and Mantinea within it.
3. This is the terrain Cleomenes is moving through in this lesson.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Five: Parts One - Four p.114-117

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

Plutarch says that when Archidamus was murdered, Cleomenes and his friends "were most blamed, as having forced his consent" (p.115). What do you think that means?

→ WRITE

• CHARACTERS

-**Lydiadas (li-DYE-uh-dus):** former ruler of Megalopolis, elected general of the Achaean League three times

-**Aristomachus (uh-RIS-tuh-MAH-kus):** newly elected general of the Achaean League

-**Agislaus #2 (uh-JESS-uh-LAY-uhs):** uncle of Agis



Term 2

After killing Lydiadas in battle, Cleomenes "caused it to be brought unto him, and putting a purple robe upon it, and a crown on his head, sent it in this array unto the very gates of the city of Megalopolis" (p.XX). What does that tell you about Cleomenes?

WEEK 5 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 17

Agis and Cleomenes p.118-123

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.7

1. Find Sparta.
2. Now find the surrounding region of Laconia. To the north is Arcadia, to the east is Argolis, to the west is Messenia.
3. These are the regions Cleomenes must hold together as king.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Six: Parts One - Two p.119-122

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are a citizen of Sparta watching Cleomenes give his speech and then immediately give up all his own wealth before asking anyone else to. "Himself first, with his step-father, Megistonus, and his friends, gave up all their wealth into one public stock, and all the other citizens followed the example" (p.120). What do you think about that?

→ WRITE

Cleomenes believed "there was no other difference betwixt a friend and a mercenary: but that the one is won with money, and the other with civility and good entertainment" (p.122). Do you agree?

• CHARACTERS

-**Cleomenes (Klee-OM-in-eez):** the last of the reforming Spartan kings

-**Sphaerus the Philosopher (SFEE-rus):** a Stoic philosopher

-**Eucleidas (yoo-KLY-das):** ruled with his brother Cleomenes

WEEK 6 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 18

Agis and Cleomenes p.123-127

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.7

1. Find Corinth at the top of the Peloponnese.
2. Find Argos to its south.
3. Find the Isthmus of Corinth (see Lesson 15). Cleomenes is moving across the northern Peloponnese, winning city after city, until the question of the Isthmus becomes the question of Greece.

• CHARACTERS

-**Hyperbatas (hy-PUR-buh-tuhs):** general of the Achaean League

-**Antigonus (an-TIG-uh-nus):** king of Macedon



Term 2

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Seven: Parts One - Two p.124-127

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

Plutarch pauses the story to say he writes about Aratus's failure "not out of any design to disgrace Aratus, for in many things he showed himself a true lover of Greece, and a great man; but to make us see the frailty and weakness of man's nature" (p.126). He is telling you directly how to read what just happened. What does it mean when the biographer steps into the story and tells you what to think? Does it change how you receive it?

→ WRITE

You are a Greek citizen watching Aratus bring Antigonos and the Macedonians into the Peloponnese. Plutarch calls it "a practice far unhonored for a Grecian, very infamous for himself, but most dishonourable for the former noble acts he had done" (p.126). What do you think about that?

WEEK 7 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 19

Agis and Cleomenes p.128-133

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.7

1. Find Corinth, Sicyon, and Argos.
2. Now trace south to Sparta.
3. Cleomenes had made himself "master of all Peloponnesus, and now lost all again in as short a time" (p.132, The Plutarch Project Volume 3).

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Eight: Parts One - Four p.129-133

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are one of the men retreating with Cleomenes when news arrives that his wife has died. Plutarch says, "he gave not place unto his sorrow, neither did grief overcome his noble courage, but he used the selfsame voice, apparel, and countenance, that he did before" (p.133). What do you think about that?

→ WRITE

• CHARACTERS

-Megistonus (meh-GISS-tuh-nus): Cleomenes's stepfather

Plutarch: Grades 6-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

You are in Argos when the city revolts against Cleomenes because he was "not releasing them from their debts as they expected" (p.132). What do you think about that?

WEEK 8 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 20

Agis and Cleomenes p.133-138

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.7

1. Find Megalopolis in Arcadia.
2. Now find the middle prong of the peninsula between the Messenian Gulf and the Laconian Gulf. The tip of that prong, not labeled on this map, is Taenarus, where Cratesiclea boarded a ship for Egypt.
3. Find Cythera, the small island just off that tip.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Nine: Parts One - Two p.135-138

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are one of the soldiers who watched Cleomenes take Megalopolis. He had "taken strict care that the city should not be plundered" before offering it back to its citizens. When they refused, he destroyed it (p.138). What do you think about what you witnessed?

→ WRITE

You are standing at the temple door, watching Cratesiclea say goodbye to her son before boarding a ship for Egypt as a hostage. She tells him, "O King of Lacedaemon, let no man see for shame, when we come out of the temple, that we have wept and dishonoured Sparta. For that only is in our power, and for the rest, as it pleaseth the gods, so let it be" (p.135). What do you think about what she chose to say?

★ TEACHER NOTE

"Ptolemy (#1)...promised him aid, but upon demand to have his mother and children in pledge."

Important Vocabulary - in pledge: as hostages.

1. They were collateral: They were the price for ships and money.

2. They were high-ranking: Only the King's own mother and children were valuable enough to secure the alliance.

3. They were voluntary (in spirit): Cratesiclea views herself not as a victim, but as a Spartan citizen fulfilling a mission that is "profitable for Sparta."

• CHARACTERS

-**Philopoemen (fil-oh-PEE-men):** leader of the Achaean League

-**Ptolemy III, #1 (TAH-luh-mee):** king of Egypt, died soon after Cleomenes's arrival

-**Panteus (PAN-tee-us):** friend of Cleomenes

WEEK 9 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 21

Agis and Cleomenes p.138-143

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.7

1. Find Argos and the territory around it, where Cleomenes marched twice to shame Antigonus into fighting or force him to lose face.
2. Now find Sellasia, just north of Sparta. This is where the final battle took place, almost within sight of home.

• CHARACTERS

-**Polybius (puh-LIB-ee-uhs):** a historian, one of Plutarch's sources



Term 2

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Ten: Parts One - Three p.139-143

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are fighting beside Cleomenes at Sellasia when his brother's flank collapses. You hear him cry out, "Alas, good brother, thou art but slain, yet thou diest valiantly, and honestly, and thy death shall be a worthy example unto all posterity" (p.142). He is still fighting when he says it. Why do you think Plutarch chose to record his exact words?

→ WRITE

You are one of the men who retreated with Cleomenes from Sellasia. You watched him walk back into Sparta, advise the citizens to yield, lean against a pillar to collect his thoughts, and then sail away. What do you think about the man you followed (p.143)?

WEEK 10 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 22

Agis and Cleomenes p.143-148

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.10-11

1. Find the Peloponnesus (p.10, Alexander's Empire).
2. From the southeastern tip of that peninsula, trace a line southeast across the open Mediterranean Sea, passing just to the west of the island of Crete, until you reach Libya and Alexandria on the coast of Egypt.

This is the voyage Cleomenes made after his final defeat at Sellasia. He left behind everything he knew to arrive at a foreign court in Alexandria to ask for help from a king who owed him nothing.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Eleven: Parts One - Three p.145-148

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are standing on the deck of a ship looking back at the disappearing coast of Greece. The war is lost. Your home is occupied. Therycion turns to you, hand on his sword, and argues that living as a "fugitive" in Egypt is a fate worse than death. Cleomenes disagrees, calling suicide a "cowardly" escape from the hard work of hope. Discuss both sides of the

★ TEACHER NOTE

Therycion's speech and Cleomenes's reply are a genuine philosophical debate, not a simple case of one man being right and one wrong. Therycion is not a coward; he is making an argument about honor and the limits of hope. Cleomenes is not dismissing death; he is making an argument about the difference between dying with purpose and dying to escape. Let students sit with the difficulty of that before asking who they think is right.

• CHARACTERS

-Ptolemy IV, #2 (TAH-luh-mee): king who mistrusted Cleomenes and was responsible for the deaths of his own mother and brother

-Sosibius (soh-SIB-ee-us): Ptolemy's chief minister



Term 2

argument. Do you think one of these men is correct (p.145-146)?

→ WRITE

"King Ptolemy (#1), at his first coming, gave Cleomenes no special good, but indifferent entertainment. But when, upon trial, he found him a man of deep sense and great reason...conversation carried with it a noble and becoming grace...he was ashamed, and repented that he had neglected so great a man" (p.146-147). Is firsthand experience the only way to judge a person's character? Does our character only count when we communicate it well to others?

WEEK 11 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 23

Agis and Cleomenes p.148-153

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.10-11

Find Alexandria in Egypt. This is where the entire final lesson takes place.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Twelve: Parts One - Three p.149-153

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are one of the thirteen Spartans. Why would you choose to "die like a man" in a foreign street rather than surrender and try to live (p.152)? What did Cleomenes understand in this moment about the difference between giving someone liberty and that person being capable of being free? Can a person be given freedom if they are already commanded by their own love of ease and safety?

→ WRITE

Panteus was the last to die. Cleomenes had commanded him to check each fallen man and die last of all. He did exactly that: walked among his friends, tested each one, and then fell on Cleomenes and slew himself. Think about what it means to be given one last duty by someone you loved and to carry it out after they are already gone. What does faithfulness look like at the very end of everything?

★ TEACHER NOTE

This is the end of two lives; Agis's half of the story ended in Lesson Three. Now Cleomenes's ends here. Ask students to look back across both men before discussing: what did they share, where did they differ, and what does Plutarch seem to think each man's story teaches?

• CHARACTERS

-**Ptolemy #3 (TAH-luh-mee):** son of Chrysermus, another Ptolemy

-**Ptolemy #4 (TAH-luh-mee):** governor of Alexandria, another Ptolemy

WEEK 12 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Plutarch Project Volume 3

Plutarch: Grades 6-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 1 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 25

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus p.155-163

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP:

- We highly recommend reading a retelling so you can be familiar with the story. This is for your understanding and should not be read to the students.
- ∞ Link: Our Young Folks' Plutarch - Tiberius Gracchus
- ∞ Link: Our Young Folks' Plutarch - Caius Gracchus
- Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ VIEW

- ∞ Image Link: Tiberius and Caius Gracchus
- ∞ Video Link: Tiberius Video
- ∞ Video Link: Gaius Video

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Rome in the center of Italy.
2. Locate Carthage in North Africa.
3. Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus were the grandsons of Scipio Africanus, the Roman commander who defeated Hannibal at the Battle of Zama in 202 BC.
4. Notice the distance between Rome and Africa; this family's influence spanned the Mediterranean world before the boys were even born.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson One: Prologue - Part Two p.160-163.

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are a Roman citizen watching the two brothers walk through the Forum. Read the descriptions of the brothers on pages 161 and 162. Which brother would you trust more to lead a revolution, and why?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Plutarch notes that Cornelia's education of her sons "prevailed more than nature" (p.161). Do you think a person's upbringing can entirely change their natural temperament?

• CHARACTERS

-**Scipio #1 (SKIP-ee-oh):** Roman general and grandfather of Tiberius and Gaius

-**Scipio #2 (SKIP-ee-oh):** adopted grandson of Scipio #1, destroyer of the city of Carthage

-**King Ptolemy VIII (TAH-luh-mee):** king of Egypt

-**Appius Claudius (AP-ee-uhs, CLAW-dee-uhs):** consul

WEEK 2 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 26

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus p.165-167

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Carthage, where Tiberius "was first to mount the walls" (p.165).

• CHARACTERS

-**Fannius (FAN-ee-us):** an orator and historian

-**Gaius Mancinus (GUY-us man-SEE-nus):** consul, captured by Numantines, returned to Rome, but stripped of his seat in the Senate



Term 3

2. Find Numantia in the northern part of Hither Spain. This is rugged, difficult territory.
3. Trace the long route from Rome, across the sea, and into the Spanish mountains. This is where Tiberius saved 20,000 Roman lives.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Two: Parts One - Two p.165-167

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are a Roman soldier trapped in the mountains of Numantia. Your Consul has failed, and you are surrounded. The enemies refuse to speak to anyone but Tiberius Gracchus. How does it feel to have your life depend on the reputation of one young officer (p.165)?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

You are a Numantine governor. You have just captured the Roman army's entire payroll and the young officer's records. Your people hate Rome. Why do you treat this specific young man like a guest of honor instead of a prisoner of war (p.166)?

WEEK 3 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 27

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus p.167-172

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Rome.
2. Now, trace a line with your finger northward along the western coast toward the Alps. This region (modern-day Tuscany) is where Tiberius looked out at the vast estates.
3. Imagine the "Roman Pink" on your map isn't a country owned by its people, but a giant puzzle where only a few wealthy men own all the pieces.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Three: Parts One - Three p.169-172

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are a wealthy Senator. You bought land legally (or so you claim) years ago. Now, a young Tribune tells you that you must give it back to the poor. Tiberius says the soldiers "have nothing but air and light" (p.171). How

• CHARACTERS

-Gaius Laelius (GUY-us, LAY-lee-us): Roman general and friend of Scipio #1

-Mucius Scaevola (MEW-shus, SEV-uh-luh): lawyer, consul, and high priest

Plutarch: Grades 6-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

would you respond?

→ WRITE (Optional Citizenship Notebook Exercise)

If you were a soldier who just returned from the wars in Spain, how would you respond to Tiberius's speech (p.171-172)?

WEEK 4 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 28

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus p.173-177

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

Find Rome. Tiberius "sealed up" the gates of the Temple of Saturn in the city of Rome to stop the economy until his law was passed (p.175, The Plutarch Project Volume 3).

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Four: Parts One - Two p.174-177

• Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are Marcus Octavius, Tiberius's friend and fellow Tribune. You believe the land law is dangerous for Rome's stability. Your best friend is now asking the people to fire you from your job. How would you respond?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Tiberius and Octavius were "vehement" against each other, but used no "foul words" (p.174). Why do you think Plutarch chose to tell us that?

• CHARACTERS

-Marcus Octavius (MAHR-kuhs, ok-TAY-vee-uhs): orator and elected tribune

-Fulvius #1 (FOOL-vee-us): consul

WEEK 5 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 29

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus p.177-182

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find the Kingdom of Pergamum (in modern-day Turkey/Asia Minor).
2. King Attalus died and left his entire kingdom to Rome. Tiberius wanted to take that royal wealth and give it directly to the poor to buy tools for their new farms. "That made him again more hated of the Senate than before" (p.180, The Plutarch Project Volume 3).

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

• CHARACTERS

-Publius Nasica (POOB-lee-uhs, nuh-SY-kuh): cousin of the Gracchi, also a Pontifex Maximus (chief priest) and consul

-King Attalus of Pergamon (AT-uh-lus, PUR-guh-mon): left his kingdom to the Romans to avoid bloodshed, very scholarly

-Titus Annius (TY-tus, AN-ee-us): consul

Plutarch: Grades 6-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Five: Parts One - Three p.179-182

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are a member of the Senate. Tiberius has just proposed that the inheritance of King Attalus should be "distributed among the poor citizens" to furnish them for their new farms (p.179). How would you respond?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Tiberius said, "But when he goeth about to take away the authority and power of the people, then he is no more a tribune" (p.181). Do you agree with that definition of leadership?

WEEK 6 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 30

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus p.182-187

□ Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

□ Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

Find Rome. Here, "were slain above three hundred men," including Tiberius (p.187, The Plutarch Project Volume 3).

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Six: Parts One - Three p.183-187

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are a supporter of Tiberius. You see him touch his head to signal he is in danger, but "his enemies, seeing the sign he gave, ran presently to the Senate, and declared that Tiberius desired the people to bestow a crown upon him, as if this were the meaning of his touching his head" (p.186). Suddenly, a mob of Senators comes charging out of the meeting, armed with broken chair legs. Do you stay to fight, or do you flee?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Tiberius was killed by a fellow Tribune with the "foot of a chair" (p.186). Plutarch notes that not one man was killed with an "iron weapon" (p.187). Why do you think Plutarch pointed this out?

• CHARACTERS

-Blossius (BLOSS-ee-us): philosopher of Cumae

-Flavius Flaccus (FLAY-vee-us, FLAK-us): supporter of the Gracchi

WEEK 7 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 31

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus p.187-192

□ Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas p.14-15

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

• CHARACTERS

-Aristonicus (uh-riss-tuh-NEE-kus): original name of Eumenes III of Pergamon

-Publius Crassus (POOB-lee-us, KRASS-us): a high priest and



Term 3

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

□ Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Rome in Italy. The Tiber River flows through it, though it is not labeled on this map. This is where the victors threw Tiberius's body, denying him a burial.
2. Now find Sardinia, the island to the southwest. This is where Gaius was sent as Quaestor to keep him away from the political fires in Rome.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Seven: Parts One - Two p.189-191

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are Gaius Gracchus. Your brother is dead, his friends were executed, and you have just had a dream where Tiberius tells you, "Brother, why dost thou prolong time...we were both predestined to one manner of life and death" (p.191). How do you feel about the dream?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Plutarch says of Gaius that "some were of opinion that he was more popular, and desirous of the common people's good will and favour, than his brother had been before him" (p.191). Do you think it was a compliment?

consul, father-in-law of Gaius Gracchus

-**Orestes (oh-REST-eez):** consul and then proconsul in Sardinia

WEEK 8 □ 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 32

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus p.192-197

□ Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

□ Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Rome in Italy. The Field of Mars lies just outside its walls, though it is not labeled on this map. Plutarch says so many people came to vote for Gaius that "the Field of Mars not being large enough to hold such a multitude of people, there were that gave their voices upon the top of houses" (p.194, The Plutarch Project Volume 3).
2. Now find Sardinia to the southwest. This is where Gaius "not only excelled all the young men of his age in his actions against his enemies" but also "in temperance, frugality, and industry, he surpassed those who were much older than himself" (p.193).

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Eight: Parts One - Three p.193-197

• CHARACTERS

-**King Micipsa (my-KIP-suh):** king of Numidia

-**Popilius (puh-PIL-ee-uhs):** consul



Term 3

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are one of the censors hearing Gaius defend himself. He tells you he "alone of all men else that had been in the wars, had carried his purse full, and brought it home empty: where others having drunk the wine which they carried thither in vessels, had afterwards brought them home full of gold and silver" (p.194). What do you think about his defense?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Plutarch says that where all other orators turned toward the Senate, Gaius, "in contrary manner when he made his oration, turned him outwards towards the other side of the marketplace" (p.196-197). Plutarch calls it "a little turning." What do you think it meant?

WEEK 9 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 33

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus p.197-202

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

Find Capua. This was one of the major cities where Gaius wanted to send poor citizens to live.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Nine: Parts One - Two p.199-202

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

Plutarch writes, "He won the good will of the common people, being more popular and familiar in his conversation and deeds than he was otherwise in his orations" (p.200). Consider the *Lives* we have studied this year. What role does a person's personality play in their success?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

The Senate has hired a rival, Livius Drusus, to "play the demagogue" and outbid you. While you offer two colonies for the "honestest citizens," he offers twelve colonies for the "poorest," letting them have the land "scot free" (p.201). As Gaius, how do you defend your laws in this situation?

• CHARACTERS

-**Fabius (FAY-bee-uhs)**: vice praetor, governor of Spain, and consul

-**Gaius Fannius (GUY-us, FAN-ee-us)**: consul

-**Livius Drusus (LIV-ee-uhs, DROO-suhs)**: appointed tribune for the sole purpose of counter-offering anything that Gaius Gracchus proposed

WEEK 10 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 34

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus p.202-206

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas p.14-15

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

• CHARACTERS

-**Fulvius (FUL-vee-us)**: aka Flavius Flaccus, supporter of the Gracchi

-**Lucius Opimius (LOO-shus, oh-PIM-ee-us)**: consul

-**Gaius Fannius (GUY-us, FAN-ee-us)**: consul



Term 3

→ LOCATE

□ Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

Look at the sea south of Capua. Gaius sailed across this water to Carthage to build a city named "Junonia." While there, a storm blew away his sacrifices, and wolves stole his boundary marks (p.204-205, The Plutarch Project Volume 3).

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Ten: Parts One - Two p.203-205

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are Gaius, back in Rome. You see one of your "familiar friends" being dragged to prison by the Consul's officers. You have promised to protect your allies, but you "pass by without assisting him," claiming you don't want to pick a quarrel. What are you thinking (p.205)?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Plutarch wrote, Gaius "came now to take a house near the marketplace, to show himself nearby the lowlier and more popular" (p.205). Why do you think he moved?

WEEK 11 □ 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 35

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus p.206-216

□ Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas p.14-15

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

□ Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Look at the city of Rome. The conflict has now moved from laws and speeches to the streets themselves.
2. Visualize the Capitol, where both parties met "by break of day." The peace is broken when an attendant named Antyllus is slain with "great bodkins to write with" rather than swords (p.209, The Plutarch Project Volume 3).

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Eleven: Parts One - Two p.208-211 and Lesson Twelve: Parts One - Epilogue p.212-215

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR - PICK 1

Plutarch wrote, "Gaius would not arm himself, but went out of his house in a long gown, as if he would have gone simply into the marketplace" (p.210). What do you think about his choices?

You are a guest at Cornelia's home in Misenum. She tells the story of her sons' deaths "without shedding a tear," as if she were telling a history of someone else. Some guests think she has lost her "reason and sense" from grief. Do you agree (p.215)?



Term 3

→ **WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE): PICK 1**
Gaius' wife says, "Alas, what hope or trust is left us now, in laws or gods, since they have slain Tiberius" (p.211)? What kind of loss do you think she is describing?

The people eventually built statues of the Gracchi and "consecrated the places where they had been slain." Looking back at their lives, did the Gracchi brothers "win" or "lose" their battle for the Roman people (p.215)? Why?

WEEK 12 **30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 36**

Exam Week

→ **EXAMS**
Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Plutarch Project Volume 3

Plutarch: Grades 6-8

Examination

Term 1

- You have followed Caesar from his early campaigns through every battle, every crisis, every triumph, and into Rome at the end. You have watched him grab sailors, swim through fire, feed horses seaweed, pardon enemies, refuse bodyguards, and finally cover his face and stop when he saw Brutus. Looking at the whole of what you witnessed: what did this man actually want, and did he ever get it?
- You are a Roman citizen who lived through all of it. Caesar was on the wrong side as a young man, nearly drowned escaping, nearly starved at Pharsalus, made himself dictator for life, died in the Senate chamber, and was declared a god three days later. The city burned. The men who killed him were hunted to their deaths. Now it is quiet. Was Rome better or worse for having had him? Why?
- You are someone who admired Caesar deeply and also someone who could see clearly what he was becoming. Those two things were both true at the same time for most of the people closest to him. Think about a person in your own life, a figure in history, or a character from a story, in whom you can see greatness and destructive behavior running alongside each other. What do you do with admiration that you cannot separate from concern?
- Tell me everything you remember about the life of Julius Caesar.

Term 2

- Tell me everything you remember about the lives of Agis and Cleomenes.
- You have watched Agesilaus, Agis's own uncle, embrace the reform publicly, help burn the debt bonds in the marketplace, laugh at the "brightest fire" he had ever seen, and then delay the land division once, and again, and again, until the moment was lost and Leonidas came back, and Agis was killed in prison. Agesilaus was not a tyrant. He was not an enemy of Sparta. He was a debtor who did not want to pay. What do you think about his behavior?
- You are a Spartan woman. You watched Agesistrata and Archidamia killed in the same prison where Agis died. You watched Cratesiclea sail to Egypt as a hostage, forcing back her tears at the temple door so her son would not see her break. You watched Agiatis, widow of a murdered king, keep her husband's dream alive and pass it on to the man she was forced to marry. You watched Chilonis choose grief twice instead of safety once. The city is quiet now. Antigonus came and went without burning anything down. Was what these women carried worth what it cost them?

Term 3

- Tell me everything you remember about the lives of the Gracchi.
- The brothers were nothing alike, and everything alike. Tiberius was gentle and restrained. Gaius was feisty. Think of a time when you had to choose between patience and urgency, when both paths seemed right, but for different reasons. Which did you choose? What happened? Which brother do you think you are more like, and which one do you think you should try to be?
- You have followed the Gracchi from Cornelia's house through every assembly, every law, every riot, and into the silence after. You watched Tiberius weep before his father's statue on the last morning of his life, and keep walking. You watched Gaius pull his hand quietly from his wife's grip at the door and not look back. You watched Cornelia lose both sons and go on hosting dinner parties for learned men without shedding a tear. What do you think about their behavior? Is there a right way to face grief, loss, and fear?